

Dormitory Management System

User Manual



Version 1.0

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Comprehensive Guide for Owners, Employees, and Tenants

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1. Introduction

1.1 System Overview

The Dormitory Management System is a comprehensive web-based application designed to streamline the management of dormitory operations. The system handles room assignments, tenant management, contract processing, invoice generation, payment tracking, utility billing, and deposit management.

Purpose

This system eliminates manual paperwork and provides real-time visibility into all aspects of dormitory operations, ensuring transparency, accountability, and efficient management.

1.2 User Roles

The system supports three distinct user roles, each with specific permissions and capabilities:

Role	Description	Key Responsibilities
Owner	Full system administrator with complete access	• Manage employees • Configure system settings • View financial reports • Manage all operations
Employee	Staff member handling daily operations	• Process payments • Record meter readings • Generate invoices • Manage laundry services
Tenant	Resident with view-only access to personal information	• View bills and invoices • Make online payments • Check deposit status • View contract details

1.3 Key Features

For Owners and Employees

- **Room Management:** Track room status, capacity, rates, and amenities

- **Contract Management:** Create and manage rental agreements with multiple tenants per room
- **Deposit System:** Track security deposits with deduction capability for damages
- **Automated Invoicing:** Generate monthly bills with electricity calculations
- **Payment Tracking:** Record and monitor payments from multiple tenants
- **Meter Readings:** Track electricity consumption for accurate billing
- **Laundry Services:** Manage laundry orders and track revenue
- **Financial Reports:** Generate comprehensive financial summaries
- **Audit Trail:** Complete logging of all system activities

For Tenants

- **Online Bill Viewing:** Access current and historical invoices
- **Payment Portal:** Pay bills securely using PayMongo integration
- **Deposit Transparency:** View deposit balance and all deductions
- **Contract Information:** Access rental agreement details
- **Payment History:** Track all payment transactions

2. Getting Started

2.1 System Requirements

The system is web-based and accessible from any device with:

- Modern web browser (Chrome, Firefox, Safari, or Edge)
- Internet connection
- Minimum screen resolution of 1024x768 pixels (desktop recommended)

2.2 Accessing the System

1 Open your web browser and navigate to the system URL

Enter the web address provided by your system administrator.

2 Login Page

You will see the login page with fields for email and password.

3 Enter your credentials

- **Email:** Your registered email address
- **Password:** Your account password

4 Click "Login"

You will be redirected to your role-specific dashboard.

First Time Users

Owners and Employees: Register using the "Register" link on the login page.

Tenants: Your account will be created by staff. You will receive a password reset email to activate your account.

2.3 First Time Login

For Tenants

When your account is created, follow these steps:

1 Check your email

You will receive a password reset email with an activation link.

2 Click the activation link

This opens the password setup page.

3 Create your password

Enter a strong password (minimum 8 characters) and confirm it.

4 Login with your new password

Return to the login page and access your tenant portal.

Security Reminder

Never share your password with anyone. The system staff will never ask for your password. If you forget your password, use the "Forgot Password" link on the login page.

3. Owner Functions

3.1 Dashboard Overview

Upon login, owners see a comprehensive dashboard displaying key metrics and recent activities.

Dashboard Components

- **Total Revenue:** Current month income from rent and services
- **Occupancy Rate:** Percentage of occupied rooms
- **Pending Payments:** Number of unpaid invoices
- **Recent Activities:** Latest system transactions
- **Quick Actions:** Shortcuts to common tasks

3.2 Room Management

The room management module allows you to track and configure all dormitory rooms.

Viewing Rooms

1 Navigate to Rooms

Click "Rooms" in the main navigation menu.

2 View Room List

The room list displays all rooms with their current status, occupancy, and rates.

Adding a New Room

1 Click "Create Room"

This opens the room creation form.

2 Fill in room details:

- **Room Number:** Unique identifier (e.g., 101, 205)
- **Floor:** Floor number
- **Capacity:** Maximum number of tenants (1-4)
- **Monthly Rate:** Base rent amount
- **Air Conditioning:** Check if room has AC
- **Meter Number:** Electricity meter identifier

3 Click "Save"

The room is created and added to the system.

Editing Room Information

1 Click "Edit" on any room

2 Update the necessary fields

3 Click "Update"

Room Status Values

- **Vacant:** Available for new tenants
- **Occupied:** Currently rented
- **Maintenance:** Under repair or renovation

3.3 Tenant Management

Manage all tenant information and accounts from this module.

Creating a Tenant Account

1 Navigate to Tenants → Create

2 Enter tenant information:

- Full Name
- Email Address
- Phone Number
- Address
- Emergency Contact
- ID Number

3 Click "Create Tenant"

The tenant account is created and a password reset email is sent automatically.

Tenant Activation

New tenants must activate their account by clicking the link in the email and setting their password before they can access the tenant portal.

Viewing Tenant Details

1 Click on a tenant name

View complete tenant profile including:

- Contact information
- Current contract details
- Payment history
- Outstanding balances

3.4 Contract Management

Contracts link rooms with tenants and define rental terms. The system supports multiple tenants per contract (room sharing).

3.4.1 Creating Contracts

Follow these steps to create a new rental contract:

1 Navigate to Contracts → Create

2 Select a room

Choose from available vacant rooms. The room rate is automatically displayed.

3 Select tenants

Choose one or more tenants from the list of available tenants. The system shows available tenants who are not currently in an active contract.

Capacity Warning

The system will warn you if you select more tenants than the room capacity. You can proceed if necessary, but it's not recommended.

4 Set contract terms:

- **Start Date:** When the contract begins
- **Due Day:** Day of month when rent is due (1-28)
- **Deposit Required:** Security deposit amount

5 Click "Create Contract"

The contract is created and the room status changes to "Occupied".

Per-Tenant Calculations

When multiple tenants share a room, the system automatically splits rent and utility bills equally among all tenants in the contract.

3.4.2 Deposit Management

The system tracks security deposits throughout the contract lifecycle. Deposits can be collected, deducted for damages, or refunded.

Viewing Deposit Information

1 Open any contract

Click on a contract number to view details.

2 Scroll to Deposit section

Located below the Invoices section on the right side.

3 Review deposit information:

- **Current Balance:** Displayed prominently at the top
- **Transaction History:** All collections and deductions
- **Staff Member:** Who recorded each transaction
- **Reasons:** Explanation for each deduction

3.4.3 Deposit Deductions

When property damage occurs, you can deduct repair costs from the security deposit. This provides transparency and accountability for both parties.

New Feature: Deposit Deduction System

Record damages and deduct costs directly from tenant deposits. All deductions are immediately visible to tenants with full reason details.

Recording a Deposit Deduction

1 Navigate to the contract

Open the contract where damage occurred.

2 Scroll to Deposit section

Find the deposit information on the right side.

3 Click "Deduct from deposit"

This expands the deduction form.

4 Fill in deduction details:

- **Amount:** Cost of repair or replacement (cannot exceed current balance)
- **Date:** When the damage occurred or was discovered
- **Reason:** Detailed explanation of the damage and repair cost

Example Reasons

- "Broken window in bedroom - glass replacement cost ₱2,500"
- "Wall paint repair - multiple holes from picture hanging ₱800"
- "Lost room key - lock replacement required ₱500"
- "Damaged door handle - replacement and installation ₱350"

5 Click "Record deduction"

A confirmation dialog appears showing the amount and warning.

6 Confirm the deduction

The deduction is recorded and balance is updated immediately.

What Happens After Deduction

- The deposit balance is reduced by the deduction amount
- The transaction appears in the deposit history

- All tenants in the contract can see the deduction and reason
- An audit log entry is created with your name and timestamp
- The new balance is displayed prominently

Important Notes

- You cannot deduct more than the current deposit balance
- Deductions are permanent and cannot be undone (contact support if needed)
- Be specific in your reason to maintain transparency
- Deductions apply to all tenants in the contract equally
- Only active contracts allow new deductions

Tenant Visibility

Tenants can view all deposit deductions in their portal under the "Deposit" section. They see:

- Current refundable balance
- Date of each deduction
- Amount deducted
- Detailed reason for the deduction
- Staff member who recorded it

Deactivating a Contract

When a tenant moves out or a contract ends:

- 1 Open the contract**
- 2 Click "Make inactive"**

This button appears at the top right of the contract page.

3 Confirm the action

A warning appears explaining that:

- All unpaid invoices will be voided
- The room will be marked as vacant
- This action cannot be undone

4 Click "OK" to proceed

Deposit Refunds

After deactivating a contract, review the remaining deposit balance. Record any final deductions before processing the refund to the tenant.

3.5 Invoice Management

The system automatically generates monthly invoices for all active contracts based on meter readings and configured rates.

Generating Invoices

1 Navigate to Invoices

2 Click "Generate Invoices"

3 Select the billing month

Choose the month for which to generate invoices.

4 Review the preview

The system shows how many invoices will be created.

5 Click "Generate"

Invoices are created for all active contracts.

Prerequisites

Before generating invoices, ensure that meter readings have been recorded for the billing month. Without meter readings, electricity charges will be zero.

Viewing Invoice Details

1 Click on an invoice number

2 Review invoice information:

- Invoice number and date
- Room and contract details
- Rent amount
- Electricity consumption and charges
- Previous balance (if any)
- Credit balance applied
- Total amount due
- Per-tenant share
- Payment status for each tenant

Invoice Statuses

Status	Description
Pending	Invoice issued but not yet due
Paid	All tenants have paid their share
Partial	Some but not all tenants have paid
Late	Past due date but within grace period
Overdue	Past grace period, action required
Void	Cancelled (usually due to contract termination)

3.6 Payment Processing

Record payments received from tenants through various payment methods.

Recording a Cash Payment

1 Open the invoice

Navigate to the invoice for which payment was received.

2 Locate "Record cash payment" panel

Found on the right side of the invoice page.

3 Select the tenant

Choose which tenant made the payment.

4 Enter payment details:

- **Amount:** Payment amount received
- **Method:** Cash, GCash, Maya, Bank Transfer, etc.
- **Date:** When payment was received
- **Reference:** Transaction reference number (optional)

5 Click "Record Payment"

The payment is recorded and invoice status is updated.

Overpayment Handling

If a tenant pays more than their share, the excess is automatically applied as credit to their next invoice.

Viewing All Payments

1 Navigate to Payments

View a complete list of all payment transactions.

2 Filter and search

Use filters to find specific payments by date, tenant, or method.

3.7 Meter Readings

Record monthly electricity meter readings to calculate consumption and billing.

Recording Meter Readings

1 Navigate to Meter Readings

2 Select the reading month

Choose the month for which you're recording readings.

3 Enter current readings

For each room, enter the current meter reading. The system automatically calculates consumption based on the previous reading.

4 Click "Save" for each room

Or use "Save All" to record all readings at once.

Progress Tracking

The system displays a progress bar showing how many rooms have readings recorded for the current month.

3.8 Reports

Generate comprehensive financial reports for analysis and record-keeping.

Available Reports

- **Revenue Summary:** Total income by month
- **Occupancy Report:** Room utilization statistics
- **Payment Collection:** Payment status and outstanding balances
- **Tenant Report:** Active tenant list with contact information

Generating Reports

1 Navigate to Reports

2 Select date range

3 Choose export format

- **CSV:** For Excel/spreadsheet analysis
- **PDF:** For printing and archiving

4 Click "Generate Report"

3.9 Employee Management

Add and manage employee accounts with appropriate permissions.

Creating Employee Accounts

- 1 **Navigate to Employees**
- 2 **Click "Create Employee"**
- 3 **Enter employee information:**
 - Full Name
 - Email Address
 - Phone Number
 - Password (employee will be prompted to change on first login)
- 4 **Click "Create"**

Managing Employee Access

Toggle employee accounts active/inactive without deleting them.

- 1 **Locate the employee**
- 2 **Click "Toggle Status"**
- 3 **Confirm the action**

Security Note

Inactive employees cannot login but their historical records (payments recorded, readings entered) remain intact for audit purposes.

3.10 Settings

Configure system-wide settings and rates.

Electricity Rate Management

- 1 **Navigate to Settings**
- 2 **Locate "Electricity Rate" section**
- 3 **Enter new rate information:**
 - **Rate per kWh:** Cost per kilowatt-hour
 - **Effective From:** Date when new rate takes effect
- 4 **Click "Update Rate"**

Rate History

The system maintains a history of all electricity rates with effective dates, ensuring accurate historical billing.

Billing Configuration

- **Default Due Day:** Standard payment due date (1-28)
- **Invoice Advance Days:** Days before month end to generate invoices
- **Grace Period:** Days after due date before marking as overdue

3.11 Audit Logs

View a complete history of all actions performed in the system.

Accessing Audit Logs

- 1 **Navigate to Audit Logs**

2 Filter logs

- By date range
- By user
- By action type
- By entity (Room, Contract, Invoice, etc.)

Audit Log Information

Each log entry contains:

- Timestamp
- User who performed the action
- Action type (Created, Updated, Deleted, etc.)
- Entity affected
- Description of the action

Compliance

Audit logs are immutable and provide a complete trail of all system activities for accountability and compliance purposes.

4. Employee Functions

4.1 Dashboard Overview

The employee dashboard provides quick access to daily operational tasks.

Employee Permissions

Employees can:

- View all rooms, tenants, and contracts
- Generate invoices
- Record payments
- Enter meter readings
- Manage laundry orders
- Deduct from deposits (for damages)

Employees cannot:

- Create or manage other employees
- Void invoices
- Modify system settings
- View financial reports

4.2 Daily Operations

Most employee tasks follow the same procedures as owner functions (see Chapter 3).

Typical Daily Tasks

1. Check for new payment notifications
2. Record cash payments received

3. Process laundry orders
4. Record meter readings (monthly)
5. Assist tenants with account issues

4.3 Laundry Services

Manage the dormitory's laundry service operations.

Creating a Laundry Order

- 1 **Navigate to Laundry**
- 2 **Click "New Order"**
- 3 **Select the tenant**
- 4 **Add services:**
 - Wash Only
 - Dry Only
 - Wash & Dry
 - Wash, Dry & Fold
 - Iron/Press
 - Dry Cleaning
- 5 **Enter quantity for each service**
- 6 **Set pickup date**
- 7 **Add notes if needed**
- 8 **Click "Create Order"**

Updating Order Status

Track orders through their lifecycle:

- **Pending:** Order received
- **Processing:** Being washed/cleaned
- **Ready:** Ready for pickup
- **Picked Up:** Completed

5. Tenant Portal

5.1 Viewing Bills

Access your current and past invoices from the tenant dashboard.

Current Bill

1 Login to tenant portal

2 View "My Bill" page

This is the default landing page showing your current month's invoice.

3 Review bill details:

- Invoice number and due date
- Your share of rent
- Your share of electricity
- Previous balance (if any)
- Total amount you owe
- Amount paid so far
- Remaining balance

Bill Breakdown

The bill page shows:

- **Room Rent:** Base room rate divided by number of tenants
- **Electricity:** Your share of electricity consumption
- **Co-tenant Status:** Payment status of roommates (if any)
- **Meter Reading:** kWh consumed and rate applied

Payment Status

You can see the payment status of your roommates to understand if the invoice has been fully paid or if there are outstanding balances.

5.2 Payment History

Track all your payment transactions.

Viewing Payment History

1 Navigate to "Payments"

2 Review payment list

Shows all your payments with:

- Date paid
- Invoice number
- Amount paid
- Payment method
- Status

5.3 Deposit Information

View your security deposit balance and transaction history with complete transparency.

Accessing Deposit Information

1 Navigate to "Deposit"

2 View deposit summary:

- **Required:** Initial deposit amount
- **Collected:** Total collected from you
- **Deductions:** Total deducted for damages
- **Refundable Balance:** Amount you'll receive at move-out

Deposit Transaction History

The deposit page displays a complete history of all transactions:

Collection Entry

- Date deposit was collected
- Amount collected
- Staff member who recorded it

Deduction Entries

- Date of deduction
- Amount deducted
- Detailed reason for deduction
- Staff member who recorded it

Transparency Feature

All deposit deductions are immediately visible to you with complete details. This ensures you understand exactly why any amount was deducted from your deposit.

Understanding Deductions

Deductions occur when property damage is repaired at the tenant's expense. Common reasons include:

- Broken windows or damaged doors

- Wall damage requiring paint repair
- Lost keys requiring lock replacement
- Damaged furniture or fixtures
- Cleaning fees for excessive mess

Disputing Deductions

If you believe a deduction was made in error, contact the management immediately. The detailed reason and date help resolve any disputes quickly.

5.4 Contract Details

View your rental agreement information.

Accessing Contract Information

1 Navigate to "Contract"

2 Review contract details:

- Contract number
- Room number and floor
- Start date
- Monthly rent (total and per tenant)
- Payment due day
- Deposit required
- Co-tenants (if any)

5.5 Online Payments

Pay your bills securely online using the PayMongo integration.

Making an Online Payment

1 Go to "My Bill"

2 Click "Pay Online"

3 Review payment amount

The system shows your outstanding balance.

4 Click "Proceed to Payment"

You'll be redirected to the secure PayMongo payment page.

5 Choose payment method:

- Credit/Debit Card
- GCash
- PayMaya
- Online Banking

6 Complete payment

Follow the PayMongo instructions to complete your payment.

7 Return to portal

After successful payment, you'll be redirected back to your portal with confirmation.

Payment Processing

Online payments are processed immediately and your invoice status is updated automatically. You'll receive a receipt via email.

Payment Security

All online payments are processed through PayMongo's secure platform. The dormitory management system never stores your payment card information.

6. Troubleshooting

6.1 Common Issues

Login Issues

Problem: Forgot Password

Solution:

1. Click "Forgot Password" on the login page
2. Enter your email address
3. Check your email for the reset link
4. Click the link and create a new password

Problem: Account Not Activated (Tenants)

Solution:

1. Check your email for the activation link
2. If you can't find it, check your spam folder
3. If still not received, contact management to resend

Problem: Account Locked

Solution:

Contact management immediately. Only administrators can unlock accounts.

Payment Issues

Problem: Online Payment Failed

Solution:

1. Check your internet connection

2. Verify your payment method has sufficient funds
3. Try a different payment method
4. If problem persists, contact PayMongo support or pay via cash

Problem: Payment Not Reflected

Solution:

1. Wait 5-10 minutes for the system to update
2. Refresh your browser
3. If still not reflected after 30 minutes, contact management with your transaction reference

Invoice Issues

Problem: Invoice Amount Seems Incorrect

Solution:

1. Check the invoice breakdown for your share
2. Verify the number of tenants in your contract
3. Review the meter reading and consumption
4. Check if there's a previous balance carried forward
5. Contact management if you still believe there's an error

Deposit Issues

Problem: Don't Understand Deposit Deduction

Solution:

1. Review the deduction reason in your deposit history
2. Check the date when the deduction was made
3. Contact management for clarification
4. Request documentation of the damage (photos, repair receipts)

Problem: Dispute a Deduction

Solution:

1. Document your concern in writing
2. Contact management within 7 days of the deduction
3. Provide any evidence supporting your claim
4. Management will review and respond within 3 business days

Technical Issues

Problem: Page Not Loading**Solution:**

1. Check your internet connection
2. Try refreshing the page (F5 or Ctrl+R)
3. Clear your browser cache and cookies
4. Try a different browser
5. Contact support if problem persists

Problem: Cannot Upload Files**Solution:**

1. Check file size (maximum 10MB)
2. Verify file format is supported
3. Try a different browser
4. Contact support if problem persists

6.2 Contact Support

Getting Help

If you cannot resolve an issue using this manual:

Support Channels

- **In-Person:** Visit the management office during business hours
- **Phone:** Call the office number provided in your contract
- **Email:** Send detailed description to the support email

When Contacting Support, Provide:

- Your full name and room number
- Description of the problem
- Screenshots (if applicable)
- Error messages (if any)
- Steps you've already tried
- Transaction reference numbers (for payment issues)

Response Times

Issue Type	Expected Response
Login/Access Issues	Same business day
Payment Issues	Within 4 hours
Billing Questions	Within 24 hours
Deposit Disputes	Within 3 business days
Technical Issues	Within 48 hours

